The Twits

By Roald Dahl adapted by David Wood

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *They're shocking!*
ACTOR 2: *They're smelly!*
ACTOR 1: *They're silly!*
ACTOR 2: *They're stupefyingly stupid!*
ACTOR 1: *Get ready to meet. . .*
ACTOR 2: *The one and only. . .*
ACTOR 1: *Thank goodness!*
TOGETHER: *The Twits! By Roald Dahl*

MRS TWIT: Mr Twit. . .. . . was a very hairy-faced man. His thick, spiky hair stuck out straight like the bristles of a nailbrush. The stuff even sprouted in revolting tufts out of his nostrils and ear-holes.

MR TWIT: My hairiness makes me look terrifically wise and grand!

MRS TWIT: But in truth he was neither of these things.: Mr Twit was a twit. He was born a twit. And now, at the age of sixty, he's a bigger twit than ever! *[MR TWIT looks angrily at MRS TWIT]* How often, you may ask, did Mr Twit wash this bristly, nailbrushy face of his? The answer is. . .

MR TWIT: Never! *[Proudly]* Not even on Sundays!

MRS TWIT: As a result there were always hundreds of bits of old breakfasts. . . and lunches. . . . and suppers. . . sticking to the hairs. *[MR TWIT licks eagerly round his face]*

MR TWIT: *[With delight]* Minced chicken livers! *[MR TWIT delves in his beard and*

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finds . . .] A piece of maggoty green cheese! *[He eats it noisily]* A mouldy old cornflake! *[MR TWIT finds it and eats it]* Or even. . . *[Digging it out]* . . . the slimy tail of a tinned sardine. *[He holds it aloft and MRS TWIT grabs it and eats it with delight]*

MRS TWIT: Mmmm. Tasty. *[MR TWIT scowls at her]*

MR TWIT: You. . . you ugly old hag! *[MRS TWIT reacts furiously, making herself look even uglier than usual]*

MRS TWIT: Ugly, yes. But not born ugly.

MR TWIT: When she was young, she had quite a pretty face. *[MRS TWIT smiles 'prettily']* But she had ugly thoughts every day. . . of every week. . . of every year. And so her face got uglier. . . and uglier. . . and uglier. . . *[MRS TWIT demonstrates]* SO ugly I can hardly bear to look at it! *[MRS TWIT scowls at MR TWIT. Then she hits him with her walking stick]* Ow! *[He holds his arm up threateningly]*

MRS TWIT NARRATES: Mr and Mrs Twit were a very happy couple. But seldom happy at the same time! For what really made them happy was . . . playing nasty tricks on one another!

[MR TWIT tiptoes to MRS TWIT, putting his finger to his lips as if to tell the audience not to say anything. Unseen by MRS TWIT, he snaps off half of her walking stick.

MR TWIT: *[Warmly]* A glass of beer, my dear?

MRS TWIT: Mmmm. Lovely. *[She goes to walk, using her stick, but it is so short she crashes to the floor] [MR TWIT laughs]* Aaaah! *[She struggles up, forced to stoop because qf the short walking stick]* What's happened? *[MR TWIT quickly removes his shoes, kneels down into them and shuffles towards her]*

MR TWIT: You seem to be growing, my sweet.

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MRS TWIT: Growing?

MR TWIT: *[Arriving and looking shorter than her]* Growing. Take a look at your stick, you old goat, and see how much you've grown in comparison.

MRS TWIT: *[Looking at her stick in amazement]* Never!

MR TWIT: You always said you wanted me to look up to you! Your wish has been granted.

MRS TWIT: I don't want to grow!

MR TWIT: No?

MRS TWIT: No! Do something!

MR TWIT: Do something? Anything?

MRS TWIT: Anything! Stop me growing!

MR TWIT: Of course, my pet. *[MR TWIT stands up, unseen by MRS TWIT, and fetches an enormous joke mallet, which he brings crashing down on her head]*

MRS TWIT: Aaah! *[MR TWIT laughs and, seen by MRS TWIT, takes the bottom half of her walking stick from off stage and replaces it]*

MR TWIT: Just a litle joke, my honey-bunny! *[MRS TWIT growls in fury.]*

MRS. TWIT NARRATES: Mrs Twit was determined to pay back Mr Twit.

PANTOMIME SEQUENCE:

[MRS TWIT smiles] [MRS TWIT checks that MR TWIT is not looking] [MRS TWIT pretends to remove her eye, revealing the glass eye (marble) and closing her real eye] MR TWIT looks round with a hint if suspicion. MRS TWIT smiles innocently. MR TWIT drinks from his glass. MRS TWIT pretends to drink from hers. Then she pretends to notice something behind MR TWIT. He turns to follow her gaze. Quickly MRS TWIT swaps the two glasses round. MR TWIT turns back, suspicious. MRS TWIT drinks from his glass, he drinks from hers]

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MR TWIT: What are you plotting?

MRS TWIT: Me plotting? You're the rotter what plots. But I'm watching you. Oh, yes! I'm watching you like a wombat!

MR TWIT: *[Sprqying her with beer as he talks]* Oh, do shut up, you old hag. *[He drains the glass and suddenly sees the glass eye at the bottom.* MR TWIT *jumps with shock]* Aaaaah! *[MRS TWIT cackles with laughter]*

MRS TWIT: I told you I was watching you! I've got eyes everywhere, so you'd better be careful! *[She retrieves the glass eye .from the glass and holds it towards MR TWIT meaningfully, then replaces it in her eye-socket]*

MRS TWIT NARRATES: Today Mr Twit has been trying, with not much success, to train monkeys for the circus he hopes to run. Now it's time for bed.

MRS TWIT: Them blooming monkeys are a waste of space.

MR TWIT: Shut up, fungus face.

MRS TWIT: A load of woolly wallies, that's all they are.

MR TWIT: That's all you know, camel-breath.

MRS TWIT: All I know is, you'll never train them chattering charlies.

MR TWIT: Yes, I will!

MRS TWIT: No, you won't!

MR TWIT: I will!

MRS TWIT: You won't!

MR TWIT: Will!

MRS TWIT: Won't!

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MR TWIT: Will!

MRS TWIT: Won't!

MR TWIT: Won't!

MRS TWIT: Will!

MR TWIT: Hah! Gotcha! *[He gets out bed]*

MRS TWIT: Where are you off to?

MR TWIT: I want a drink.

MRS TWIT: You want a brain.

[She laughs heartily, then dozes off; snoring gently] [MR TWIT starts to drink]

MR TWIT: *[Mr Twit was reminded of the time when had suddenly seen the eye staring at him.]* . . . Aaaah! *[Deciding to pay Mrs. Twit back, MR TWIT reaches into his beard and brings out a large, slimy frog].* Come on, fat froggy, do your slimy, grimy worst! *[Smiling in anticipation, he tiptoes over to the bed and slips the frog under the sheet near MRS TWIT's feet] [Pause]*

MRS TWIT: *[Suddenly]* Aaaaaah! *[She bounces about]*

MR TWIT: What's the matter, light of my life?

MRS TWIT: Help! There's something in the bed!

MR TWIT: I'll bet it's that Giant Skillywiggler!

MRS TWIT: What Skigglewilly? Ah! It's all slimy!

MR TWIT: The Giant Skillywiggler that jumped out of my suitcase when I got home from Africa.

MRS TWIT: Never!

MR TWIT: Yes. I tried to kill it, but it got away. It disappeared under a pile of

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your knickers!

MRS TWIT: Help! Save me! It's crawling on my feet!

MR TWIT: It's got teeth like screwdrivers.

MRS TWIT: Aaaah!

MR TWIT: It'll bite off your toes!

MRS TWIT: Aaaah!

MR TWIT: And nibble your knees*!* *[The frog jumps up on to MRS TWIT'S face]* My nose! My nose! *[MR TWIT grabs the frog and holds it up]*

MR TWIT: By golly, it *is* a Giant Skillywiggler!

MRS TWIT: Aaaah! You scrabby old scumbag! You sneaky old snake! You scheming old scallop! You wait! You wait!

MRS TWIT NARRATES: Mrs Twit, as you might expect, did not forget about her husband's Giant Skillywiggler joke. Next day, at lunchtime, she decided to pay him back.

MRS TWIT: *[MRS TWIT, goes to the stove. She sings innocently as she picks up the saucepan]* La, la, la, la, la, la, laaaa! *[Calling]* My dearest! Why don't I make us each a nice, mouth watering bowl of spaghetti? Eh?

MR TWIT: Mmm. Yes. Why not, my little dumpling? Good idea. Spaghetti. I like spaghetti.

[MRS TWIT puts spaghetti in the saucepan] [Then, unseen by MR TWIT, MRS TWIT takes some squiggly, squirming worms from her pocket and drops them into MR TWIT'S bowl. She brings the bowls to the table]

MRS TWIT: *[Sweetly]* Your spaghetti, my dreamboat, my dove!

MR TWIT: Mmm. Scrummy. *[He picks up his fork and goes to take some spaghetti]* Hey,

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my spaghetti is moving.

MRS TWIT: What's that, my angel-puss?

MR TWIT: It's all squirmy.

MRS TWIT: It's a new kind. It's called Squiggly Spaghetti. It's delicious. Eat it up while it's nice and hot. [*MR TWIT starts to tuck in, forking up the spaghetti and shoveling it into his mouth, slurping and leaving a mess on his beard. MRS TWIT watches eagerly]*

MR TWIT: *[Chewing hard]* It's not as good as the ordinary kind. It's too squishy.

MRS TWIT: Oh? I find it very tasty.

MR TWIT: *[Swallowing a mouthful]* I find it rather bitter. It's got a distinctly bitter flavour. Buy the other kind next time. *[But he goes on eating, with the occasional burp] [MRS TWIT can hardly contain her delight. As he finishes his plateful. . .]*

MRS TWIT: You want to know why your spaghetti was squirmy and squishy?

MR TWIT: Why?

MRS TWIT: And why it had a nasty bitter taste?

MR TWIT: Why?

MRS TWIT: Because it was worms! *[She roars with laughter]* Because it was WORMS!

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AWARDS

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